SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 23

Field History Tracking & Feed Tracking

Complete Guide — Auditing Field Changes & Collaborative Real-Time Feeds

- What is Field History Tracking?
- Audit Trails & Compliance Value
- Enable Tracking & History Related List
- What is Feed Tracking in Chatter?
- Team Collaboration in Real-Time
- Field History vs. Feed Tracking

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	CORE COMPETENCY
23 of Series	~17 Minutes	Intermediate	Auditing & Collaboration

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:45

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In previous lessons, we covered support automation using *Web-to-Lead*, *Web-to-Case*, and *Email-to-Case*.

As organizations grow and multiple users collaborate on records, critical questions inevitably arise:

- *"Who changed that high-value deal from ₹50,000 to ₹75,000?"*
- *"When exactly was the customer's phone number or discount approved?"*
- *"How can teammates see important record updates in real time like a social media timeline?"*

Salesforce provides two complementary features to solve these challenges: **Field History Tracking** (for historical compliance and audit logging) and **Feed Tracking** (for real-time team collaboration in Chatter).

SECTION 2

What is Field History Tracking & Why Do We Need It?

⏱ 0:45 – 4:00

💰 REAL-WORLD SCENARIO: THE OPPORTUNITY AMOUNT MYSTERY

Suppose a sales representative edits a key Opportunity record and increases the **Amount from ₹50,000 to ₹75,000**. Later in the quarter, the sales VP reviews the pipeline and wonders: *Who made this change? When was it altered? What was the previous value?* Without an audit trail, pinpointing the change is nearly impossible.

📌 DEFINITION

Field History Tracking is an auditing feature in Salesforce that automatically logs changes made to selected fields on an object, recording the *Field Name*, *Original (Old) Value*, *New Value*, *User who changed it*, and exact *Date/Time* stamp.

🎯 Core Business Benefits of Field History Tracking

- **Regulatory & Legal Compliance:** Supports strict auditing requirements (e.g., SOX, HIPAA, ISO) where financial and personal data alterations must be auditable.
- **Accountability & Transparency:** Identifies which teammate modified specific values, preventing guesswork and confusion.
- **Dispute Resolution:** If a customer claims their agreed billing rate or address was overwritten, admins can trace the exact historical update.
- **High Value Across Key Objects:** Commonly enabled on `Account`, `Contact`, `Lead`, `Opportunity`, `Case`, and Custom Objects.

💡 STANDARD GOVERNOR LIMIT

Salesforce allows you to track up to **20 fields per object** out-of-the-box (can be extended up to 60 with Salesforce Shield Field Audit Trail).

SECTIONS 3 & 4 — HANDS-ON TUTORIAL

Enabling Field History Tracking & Viewing History

⏱ 4:00 – 7:30

Part A: Enabling Field History Tracking in Object Manager

1. Click the ⚙ **Setup** gear icon in top right.
2. Navigate to **Object Manager** and select the target object (e.g., `Account`).
3. Click **Fields & Relationships** in the left sidebar menu.
4. Click the **Set History Tracking** button in the top action header.
5. Check the box to **Enable Account History** (or Object History).
6. Select up to 20 fields to monitor (e.g., `Phone`, `Industry`, `Rating`, `Website`, `Annual Revenue`).
7. Click **Save**. History tracking is now activated!

Part B: Viewing Tracked History on Records

1. Ensure the **Account History** (or Object History) Related List is placed on the object's Page Layout.
2. Open any active record (e.g., Acme Corp Account).
3. Edit one of the tracked fields (e.g., change **Rating** from *Warm* to *Hot*) and save.
4. Scroll down to the **Account History** related list to view the audit log entry.

Example of What the History Log Looks Like:

Date / Time	Field	User	Original Value	New Value
04/10/2026, 11:24 AM	Rating	Alex Admin	Warm	**Hot**
02/10/2026, 03:15 PM	Phone	Sarah Sales	(555) 019-2834	**(555) 998-1200**

SECTIONS 5 & 6 — COLLABORATION

What is Feed Tracking & How to Enable It?

⏱ 7:30 – 13:00

📱 SOCIAL MEDIA FEED FOR ENTERPRISE CRM

Think of Feed Tracking like a Facebook or LinkedIn timeline post on a record. Instead of having to open history tables or email teammates, whenever a key milestone happens (like an Opportunity stage advancing), Salesforce **automatically posts an update to the record's Chatter Feed** so followers can comment, like, and collaborate immediately!

📌 DEFINITION

Feed Tracking connects field modifications directly to Salesforce Chatter. When configured fields are updated, an automated post is published to the record's Chatter Feed, notifying everyone following that record.

Part A: Enabling Feed Tracking in Setup

1. In ⚙ **Setup**, type `Feed Tracking` into Quick Find and select it.
2. From the list of available objects on the left, select your target object (e.g., `Account` or `Opportunity`).
3. Check the box to **Enable Feed Tracking**.
4. Select the specific fields you want to publish to Chatter (up to **20 fields per object**).
5. Click **Save**.

Part B: Observing the Automated Chatter Post

When a user updates a tracked field (e.g., moving an Opportunity stage), an automatic post appears in the feed:

SF

Sarah Sales updated this record:

`Stage: Qualification → Proposal/Price Quote`

Just now • Comment • Like • Share

👥 TEAM SYNERGY

Coworkers following this record get notified instantly on their Chatter feed or mobile app, allowing reps, sales engineers, and managers to coordinate next steps without scheduling a meeting or sending internal emails.

SECTION 7 — ARCHITECTURAL COMPARISON

Field History Tracking vs. Feed Tracking

⏱ 13:00 – 15:00

Comparison Criterion	Field History Tracking	Feed Tracking
Primary Purpose	Official auditing, compliance & recordkeeping	Team collaboration, communication & social feed
Where Does it Display?	**History Related List** at bottom of page	**Chatter Feed** (Feed tab / Activity timeline)
Captures Old & New Values?	✅ Yes (Old Value and New Value columns)	✅ Yes (Displays change description in post)
Captures User & Timestamp?	✅ Yes (Exact time & user name logged)	✅ Yes (Poster name & post time)
Interactive Discussion?	❌ No (Static audit table only)	✅ Yes (Teammates can Like, @mention, Comment)
Requires Chatter?	❌ No (Works independently of Chatter)	✅ Yes (Requires Chatter to be enabled)
Standard Field Limit	Up to **20 fields** per object	Up to **20 fields** per object

MEMORY RULE FOR THE ADMIN EXAM

Field History Tracking = AUDITING & COMPLIANCE (Static log for management & auditors)
Feed Tracking = COLLABORATION & SOCIAL (Interactive stream for sales & service teams)

SECTION 8

Admin Best Practices

⏱ 15:00 – 16:00

HISTORY BEST PRACTICES

Auditing & Data Hygiene

- **Track Only Critical Fields:** Don't waste the 20-field quota on trivial text fields; prioritize financial amounts, stages, status, and sensitive customer data.
- **Regular Audits:** Periodically review tracked fields to align with evolving organizational compliance policies.
- **Data Retention Aware:** Standard Field History is retained for 18 months via UI and up to 24 months via API.

FEED BEST PRACTICES

Chatter Collaboration

- **Avoid Feed Fatigue:** Tracking too many rapid-fire fields clutters the Chatter feed with spam, making genuine discussions harder to find.
- **Focus on Milestones:** Track fields that signal big transitions (e.g., *Stage*, *Case Status*, *Escalated*).
- **Encourage @mentions:** Coach team members to tag colleagues in feed comments rather than emailing them.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 23

01

Field History Tracking creates an unalterable audit trail recording field name, old value, new value, modified by, and timestamp.

02

Configured via **Object Manager** → **[Object]** → **Fields & Relationships** → **Set History Tracking** (max 20 fields).

03

Viewed by users through the **[Object] History Related List** placed directly on the Record Page Layout.

04

Feed Tracking turns field updates into automated Chatter posts on the record's social activity feed.

05

Configured via **Setup** → **Feed Tracking** to foster cross-team collaboration and eliminate manual progress emails.

06

Remember the core distinction: **History Tracking is for Auditing**; **Feed Tracking is for Collaboration**.

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 24

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!